Bob, managing field operations in three different regions, faced a different frustration. “I’m in the sales-manager role,” he said, “but I only need access to my own region’s accounts. Why do I either have too little or too much?”

Meanwhile, Carol—who had stepped into a security administrator role—was observing all of this from a different perspective. Her dashboards showed sprawling role definitions and audit logs filled with role-based exceptions. Permissions were being assigned informally by adding users to increasingly specific roles. Most concerning, access policies were beginning to diverge across systems once more. What had once been a straightforward model had now become a patchwork. It was clear that ACME Corp’s access requirements had outgrown static authorization.

The team didn’t want to abandon RBAC entirely. Still, they needed a more expressive model—one that could adapt to context, capture relationships, and support fine-grained rules reflecting how people actually worked. That’s when they started adopting dynamic authorization models.

In their new Customer Collaboration platform, they implemented Relationship-Based Access Control (ReBAC). Instead of relying on team-wide roles, access was granted based on whether a user was assigned as a viewer, editor, or owner of a document. Alice was now able to access project files she was involved in, even when those projects spanned different departments.

Within their internal systems, they began using Attribute-Based Access Control (ABAC) to define permissions that took into account region, clearance, and time of day. Bob’s access to customer data was now governed by his assigned region and the sensitivity of the record rather than a one-size-fits-all role.

For Carol, the change meant fewer exceptions, increased visibility, and greater confidence that the company’s access controls aligned with both business needs and security policies.

Dynamic models didn’t replace RBAC at ACME Corp—they complemented it. Where roles still made sense, they stayed. But now, access decisions could reflect the context, relationships, and conditions that mattered most.